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Transcripción de audio

IELTS Academic · Set 16

01 Comprensión auditiva - Sección 1: Inscripción de niños en un campamento de verano

Officer: Good morning, Sunnyside Summer Camp. How can I help?

Parent: Hi there. I'd like to register my children for one of your summer camps.

Officer: Wonderful. Let me take a few details. Could I have your name?

Parent: Yes, my first name's Michael.

Officer: Before we begin the formal record, I should explain how I handle a summer-camp registration. I will check the main requirement first, then compare the practical options, and finally read the record back. That gives us a chance to correct a misunderstanding before anything is confirmed.

Parent: That approach would be helpful for the summer-camp registration. I made some notes beforehand, although I was not sure whether every detail I found still applied, so I would rather verify it during this conversation.

Officer: And your surname?

Parent: It's Fletcher - shall I spell that? F-L-E-T-C-H-E-R.

Officer: Perfect, thank you. And the best number to reach you on?

Parent: For this summer-camp registration, I am not simply looking for the cheapest possibility. I need to understand what the standard arrangement includes and what would count as an optional extra, because changing plans later could be inconvenient.

Officer: Of course. In this summer-camp registration, I will flag any condition that depends on availability, and you can stop me whenever two alternatives sound too similar.

Parent: My mobile is 07700 900642.

Officer: Let me just repeat that - 07700 900642.

Parent: That's the one.

Officer: A summer-camp registration can involve names, dates and choices that differ in only one important detail. I will therefore use the full wording and repeat any number in a separate group. Please ask immediately if something conflicts with your notes.

Parent: I will. For the summer-camp registration, I would prefer to correct a small point now, especially because I may need to coordinate this with another commitment.

Officer: Great. And how many children are you registering today?

Parent: I was going to bring three, but my eldest has other plans now, so just 2.

Officer: No problem, 2 children. Now, we run several kinds of camp. Were you interested in the sports camp?

Parent: I looked at that, but I think they'd both prefer the adventure camp - they love being outdoors.

Officer: Let me finish the summer-camp registration by summarising what I have recorded. For this summer-camp registration, I will repeat the selected arrangement, spell any unusual word, and explain what happens next. The summary closes the summer-camp registration, so even a minor correction is worth making now.

Parent: Good. During the summer-camp registration, I will listen carefully and make sure no assumption has slipped in.

Officer: A popular choice. The camp runs every weekday, starting at 9 am and finishing at 4 pm.

Parent: That works well for us.

Officer: Now, a few things to remember. Children should bring a packed lunch each day, as we don't provide meals. And because they'll be outside a lot, please make sure they've applied sunscreen before they arrive.

Parent: Before we close the summer-camp registration, could you tell me how I should raise a question after today? I would prefer not to repeat the whole enquiry if one detail changes.

Officer: Certainly. Keep the reference on the confirmation and quote it when you contact us. A colleague can then see the agreed record, identify the single point that needs attention and explain whether the change affects anything else.

Parent: Understood. And what does it cost?

Officer: It depends on their ages. Our Juniors programme is for children aged 6 and over, and that's £90 per week. Juniors also each receive a free cap to wear on trips.

Parent: And for older children?

Officer: Before I close this summer-camp registration, I will separate the details we have confirmed from the points that remain optional. Please listen to the complete summary before responding, because correcting one item can sometimes affect a later choice as well. I will keep the original order so that it is easy to compare with your notes.

Parent: That is helpful. I will check each detail as you read it and ask about anything that does not match what I intended. Once the summary is accurate, I will also note the reference and the method for making a later amendment.

Officer: That would be our Explorers programme. The minimum age for that is 9, and it's a little more - £120 a week, because it includes more excursions. Explorers are given a free backpack instead of a cap.

Parent: Right. My two are 8 and 11, so I suppose that's one in each.

Officer: Exactly. I'll set that up for you now.

02 Comprensión auditiva - Sección 2: Lanzamiento de un programa de reciclaje

Good evening, everyone, and thank you for coming to the launch of our town's new recycling scheme. I'm Sarah, from the council's environment team, and I'm here to explain how the scheme will work and what it means for you. Let me start with the most important change. From next month, every household will receive a brand-new recycling bin. To make it easy to identify, these bins are green, quite different from the black bins we use for general rubbish. Before describing the individual features of this recycling-scheme launch, it is useful to understand the overall sequence. The information for the recycling-scheme launch follows the order in which most people encounter the site or activity, moving from the arrival point to the places that need closer explanation.

Knowing that sequence will make the later directions and choices in the recycling-scheme launch easier to follow. Now, what can go in them? You'll be pleased to hear the list is generous. Glass bottles and jars are fine, as are cardboard and newspapers. However, there are two things we cannot accept. Please do not put plastic bags in the recycling bin - they jam our sorting machines. And, secondly, any container that is still covered in food cannot be recycled either; food-contaminated packaging has to go in the general waste. Some arrangements connected with the recycling-scheme launch may have changed since older information was prepared. During the recycling-scheme launch, listen for the difference between a permanent feature and something available only at a stated time.

Where a condition in the recycling-scheme launch is fixed, it will be presented as a rule; where there is flexibility, it will be described as a recommendation. As for collections: your green bin will be emptied on a Wednesday. Note that this won't be every week - collections are fortnightly, so once every two weeks. We'll post a calendar through your door showing the exact dates. As the recycling-scheme launch continues, access and movement need to remain clear for everyone. Within the recycling-scheme launch, a change to a minor detail does not necessarily alter the main programme. If an alternative becomes necessary during the recycling-scheme launch, wait for the full announcement before moving, because the first place mentioned may be the one that is no longer available.

The new bins will be delivered to all homes by 30 June, so please look out for yours. If your household is large and you feel you need a bigger bin, you can request one by calling our recycling helpline; the number is on our leaflet. To encourage everyone to take part, we're running a little competition. Each month, one household that recycles particularly well will win a shopping voucher worth fifty pounds. Do not try to memorise every detail of the recycling-scheme launch at once. The route will make more sense once its main stages are connected. For now, concentrate on where the activity begins, which direction or sequence applies, and the point at which you may need to make a choice or ask a member of staff. Why are we doing all this?

Our goal is ambitious but achievable: we aim to reduce the amount of waste sent to landfill by 40 percent within two years. A final way to follow the recycling-scheme launch is to separate descriptive information from an instruction that requires action. Examples make the layout memorable, but only stated directions determine the route. Keeping those functions separate will prevent an interesting

detail from being mistaken for a change to the programme. Finally, for those of you who'd like to recycle food scraps as well, a free kitchen caddy is available from the town hall - just ask at the front desk. If you become uncertain during the recycling-scheme launch, pause at the next staffed point rather than following another group without checking.

Explain the last location or instruction you clearly remember, and staff can reconnect you with the correct sequence. This is especially important when two activities begin near one another or when a temporary diversion changes only one section of the route. The programme is designed to allow questions, so asking for clarification will not make you miss the main activity. Thank you, and let's make this a success.

03 Comprensión auditiva - Sección 3: Revisión de un prototipo de ingeniería

Tutor: Right, Liam, Sophie - let's review your prototype. Talk me through it.

Sophie: Of course. Our brief was to design a low-cost water filter for use in rural areas without mains electricity. The main aim was to make it as affordable as possible, so anyone could build one.

Tutor: Before we settle on an interpretation for the engineering prototype, we should separate what the evidence actually shows from what we expected to find. Our first idea may still help organise the work, but it should not decide how we describe the result.

Sophie: Agreed. For the engineering prototype, we can identify which claims are supported and which remain tentative. That will make the argument more credible.

Tutor: That's a genuinely worthwhile goal - millions of people still lack access to clean drinking water, so a cheap, simple solution really does matter.

Tutor: And what have you built it from?

Sophie: We also need to be careful about cause and association in the engineering prototype. Two patterns can occur together without one necessarily producing the other, particularly when the sample is small, participants select themselves, or an uncontrolled factor affects both.

Tutor: Yes. We should match the strength of each claim to the method.

Liam: The outer casing is a simple plastic bottle. We did consider using metal, which is more durable, but plastic is far cheaper and lighter, and that fitted our budget better.

Tutor: Sensible. And the filtering material itself?

Tutor: Another question is whether our categories for the engineering prototype are precise enough for somebody else to repeat the procedure. We know what we intended because we designed it, but a reader only has the written definition.

Sophie: For the engineering prototype, let us include one clear example and one borderline case. That should reveal any ambiguity before the final version.

Sophie: We used layers of sand and charcoal. The charcoal is the key part - it removes impurities and improves the taste of the water.

Tutor: Good. Now, how did testing go?

Sophie: The order of the engineering prototype presentation matters as much as the individual sections. If we give every technical detail before explaining the central question, the audience may lose the thread.

Tutor: For the engineering prototype, we can use the assessment criteria as a final checklist rather than relying on whether the draft feels polished.

Liam: Mostly well, but we did hit one problem. When we ran dirty water through it quickly, the filter clogged up, and the flow almost stopped. We had to pour the water in much more slowly.

Tutor: That's useful to know. My main concern, though, isn't the flow rate - it's safety. Your filter removes dirt and improves taste, but it won't kill bacteria. For drinking water, that's a serious gap.

Tutor: Our final review of the engineering prototype should use the agreed criteria rather than simply whether we like the finished version. We need consistent terminology, evidence for each claim and a conclusion that answers the question without exaggeration.

Sophie: I will turn those points into a checklist. Then we can sign off each requirement before calling the revision complete.

Sophie: You're right. We hadn't fully addressed the bacteria issue.

Tutor: So here's what I'd suggest for the next version. First, reduce the weight further so it's easier to carry. Second, bring the cost down even more if you can. Third, add a stage that disinfects the water - perhaps a UV step. Fourth, do much more testing with different water samples. And finally, prepare a clear diagram for your report so the design is easy to follow.

Sophie: We should keep a note of any decision we change during the final review of the engineering prototype, including the reason for it.

Tutor: Agreed. That record will stop us from reopening settled points without new evidence, and it will show which revision corrected a real weakness rather than merely changing the wording.

Liam: That all makes sense. The disinfection stage is the priority, clearly.

Tutor: Absolutely. Get that right and it's a strong project.

Tutor: Before we finish the engineering prototype, let us read the argument from the perspective of somebody who did not collect the evidence. Each claim should identify what was observed, how it was measured and which limitation affects the interpretation.

Sophie: I will also check that our recommendation follows from the result rather than from what we expected at the beginning. If a sentence sounds stronger than the method allows, we can narrow it without losing the main point.

Tutor: Good. Then the final version will show a clear line from the research question through the evidence to the conclusion.

Sophie: Thanks. We'll start work on the next version straight away.

04 Comprensión auditiva - Sección 4: Navegación de las aves

Good afternoon. Today we're going to explore one of the great mysteries of the natural world: how migrating birds find their way. Every year, billions of birds travel enormous distances between their breeding and wintering grounds - some species cover more than ten thousand kilometres in a single journey - and yet they arrive with astonishing accuracy. How do they do it? The answer is that birds rely not on one method but on several, combining them like tools in a navigator's kit. To place the bird-navigation lecture in perspective, we need to distinguish the familiar modern description from the longer process that produced it. Within the bird-navigation lecture, what now appears stable often emerged through small changes whose significance became visible only later.

A simple list of events in the bird-navigation lecture can hide those alternatives, so the discussion will emphasise why particular changes mattered. The first tool is the sky. During the day, many birds orient themselves using the position of the sun, adjusting for the fact that it moves across the sky as the hours pass. At night, other species switch to the stars, using the fixed point around which the night sky appears to rotate to work out which way is north. Evidence for the bird-navigation lecture does not come from a single source. Researchers may compare controlled findings with patterns observed outside the laboratory. Each source answers a different question and carries its own uncertainty.

Agreement can increase confidence, while disagreement often reveals an assumption or a measurement problem that deserves closer examination. Perhaps the most remarkable tool is a kind of internal compass. Birds can sense the Earth's magnetic field, and use it to determine direction even when the sky is hidden by cloud. Exactly how they detect it is still debated, but many researchers now believe the sense is linked to special molecules in the birds' eyes, which may allow them, in effect, to "see" magnetic lines. Scale is especially important when evaluating the bird-navigation lecture. A process observed in one case, one community or one short trial may behave differently across a region or over several generations. In this bird-navigation lecture, examples at different scales will therefore be compared.

This comparison helps identify which conditions are essential and which are merely helpful. Some species add yet another sense to the mix. Seabirds in particular appear to use their sense of smell, building up a kind of odour map of the ocean that helps them relocate distant islands. It is also worth noticing the language of certainty used in the bird-navigation lecture. Some mechanisms are supported by direct observation, while others remain the best explanation available from indirect evidence. The final account should separate established patterns from reasonable inference. Keep that distinction in mind as the examples are brought together. Navigation is also partly inherited.

Young birds making their very first migration alone are guided by instinct, following a direction and distance encoded in their biology. Older, experienced birds supplement this with memory, recognising landmarks such as coastlines, mountain ranges and large rivers. The separate examples in the bird-navigation lecture can finally be organised around three questions: what conditions begin a change, which mechanisms sustain it, and what consequences appear later. For the bird-navigation lecture, that structure keeps chronology from becoming a list of disconnected

facts. The conclusion to the bird-navigation lecture will use that framework to connect the details without extending them beyond the available evidence. Sadly, human activity is making navigation harder.

Artificial light at night - what we call light pollution - draws birds off course and causes fatal collisions with buildings. A useful final check is to ask what observation would make the present account of the bird-navigation lecture less convincing. Identifying such evidence keeps the explanation testable and reveals where future research would be most informative. It also prevents a plausible narrative from being treated as complete merely because its separate examples fit together. To understand all this, scientists now fit migrating birds with tiny electronic tags, which record their position and reveal, for the first time, the astonishing routes these travellers take. One final point about the bird-navigation lecture concerns the difference between a useful model and a complete explanation.

A model selects the relationships that matter most for a particular question, so it can be informative even when it leaves out local variation. Problems arise when that simplification is forgotten and a result from one scale is treated as a rule for every case. The evidence discussed here should therefore be read with its conditions attached: the period observed, the population or material studied, the method used and the uncertainty that remains. Those conditions do not weaken the account; they show exactly where the conclusion is supported and where further observation would be needed.